

Sunday, 9 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 32° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 28° 19°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 17°	GLASGOW Drizzle 18° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Counter-terror police have reopened an investigation into an incident at Nigel Farage's home, the BBC understands.

They're looking into an 'attempted burglary' last year, following the death of the former MP. It's a significant development in a high-profile case.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Victims of convicted sex offender Simon Levy are being urged to come forward, as police face accusations of serious failures.

The Met and British Transport Police believe there may be more victims. This comes amidst ongoing criticism of how investigators handled previous cases.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Travellers at Bristol Airport have described the disruption as a 'shambles' after 14 hours of flight cancellations.

Flights are now restarting, but passengers should still expect delays and diversions. It's been a frustrating time for many trying to get away.

TRAVEL · UK
- 4

A man has been found guilty of the fatal shooting of a teenager outside a club in Wembley.

Tyrece Balcha was tragically found with gunshot wounds. This case has drawn significant attention in the local community.

CRIME · UK
- 5

A man has been charged after four people were killed in a lamp-post crash.

James Diggie faces four counts of aiding and abetting causing death by dangerous driving. It's a truly tragic incident that has shocked the community.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1

Pop star Self Esteem is set to make her big screen debut in an upcoming film called 'Mountain'.

The singer will star in the movie from Welsh director Celyn Jones. It's set in the 1980s, so expect some great retro vibes!

ON AIR – What's your favourite film set in the 80s? Any iconic movies you'd recommend?

FILM · COMING UP

2

Fans are hoping for a new Fugees album after Lauryn Hill revealed the band is 'in an amazing place'.

She says they've gone through 'an incredible healing process'. Could we finally get new music from them after 30 years?

ON AIR – Are you excited for new Fugees music? What's your favourite track by them?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3

Emmerdale actor Lawrence Robb, who plays Mackenzie Boyd, has joined the line-up for this year's Strictly Come Dancing!

He's also appeared in 'I Hate Suzie', so he's no stranger to the screen. Will his soap opera moves translate to the dancefloor?

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on Strictly this year? Any early predictions for the winner?

TV · COMING UP

4

Rihanna is 'in the studio' and 'cooking' up new music, according to her partner A\$AP Rocky!

The singer hasn't released a full album since 2016, so fans are eagerly awaiting her return. It sounds like something big is on the way!

ON AIR – What kind of sound are you hoping for from Rihanna's new music? What's your favourite Rihanna hit?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5

A brand new exhibition celebrating the legendary Sir Billy Connolly is coming to Glasgow in 2027.

Called 'Billy Connolly's Big Wee Exhibition', it will be at the city's Kelvingrove Art Gallery from next June. A fantastic tribute to a national treasure!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Billy Connolly? What's your favourite memory or routine of his?

EXHIBITION · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 **Premier League champions Arsenal have made a huge signing, bringing in Brazil midfielder Bruno Guimaraes from Newcastle United.**
The deal is reportedly worth £75m. It's a massive move that will definitely get fans talking ahead of the new season.
ON AIR – Arsenal fans, how do you feel about this signing? And Newcastle supporters, will you miss Guimaraes?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 2 **The Scottish FA is reportedly close to appointing a new head coach to replace Steve Clarke.**
Excitement is building as the search for a new leader for the national team nears its end. Who do you think it might be?
ON AIR – Who would you like to see take the top job for Scotland? Any strong candidates come to mind?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **Nat Sciver-Brunt was in superb form, guiding Trent Rockets into the knockout stage of The Hundred.**
She hit an unbeaten 67 as the Rockets secured an emphatic nine-wicket win over MI London. What a performance!
ON AIR – Are you enjoying The Hundred this year? Which team are you backing to win?
CRICKET · UK

- 4 **Liverpool are reportedly close to signing Uruguay defender Ronald Araujo on a season-long loan from Barcelona.**
The deal is said to include an option to purchase the player permanently. It could be a big boost for their defence!
ON AIR – Liverpool fans, what do you make of this potential signing? Is he the right fit for the team?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 5 **Premier League newcomers Coventry City have completed the club-record signing of Ghana midfielder Caleb Yirenkyi.**
It's a huge statement of intent from Coventry as they prepare for life in the top flight. What a way to kick off their season!
ON AIR – Coventry fans, how excited are you about this record signing? Do you think he'll make a big impact in the Premier League?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent trend sees more people embracing 'micro-adventures' for a quick dose of escapism.**
These short, local explorations, like a sunset walk or an overnight campout in the garden, offer a refreshing break without the need for extensive planning or travel.
- 2 The surprising joy of 'rediscovering forgotten hobbies' is bringing a new sense of purpose to many.**
Dusting off an old paint set or picking up a musical instrument from years ago is proving to be a wonderful way to unwind and express creativity.
- 3 Experts are suggesting that 'having a designated 'worry-free' zone' in your home can significantly boost mental well-being.**
This could be a comfy chair or a quiet corner where stressful thoughts are consciously left at the door, allowing for true relaxation.
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the 'calming effect of watching fish in an aquarium' for reducing stress.**
The gentle movements and tranquil underwater world offer a peaceful distraction, proving that sometimes, the simplest things are the most soothing.
- 5 The humble 'garden gnome' is making a stylish comeback, with designers creating contemporary and artistic versions.**
No longer just a quirky garden ornament, these little figures are now seen as a fun way to add personality and a touch of whimsy to outdoor spaces.
- 6 A study reveals the 'comforting power of reading aloud' as a shared activity for families.**
Whether it's a bedtime story or a chapter from a favourite novel, this simple act fosters connection and creates lasting memories.
- 7 The unexpected delight of 'finding an unusually shaped vegetable' is sparking creativity in the kitchen.**
Instead of discarding them, many are embracing these quirky carrots or wonky courgettes, turning them into fun and imaginative dishes.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to put our laundry away, even though we know it might not be the tidiest approach?

ANSWER: JUST MAKING A BIG PILE ON A CHAIR, HOPING IT'LL MAGICALLY SORT ITSELF OUT.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of toast. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY BREAKING OFF THE CRUSTS FIRST, EVEN IF WE'RE GOING TO EAT THEM ANYWAY.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a particular 'old-fashioned phrase' that just makes you smile because it's so wonderfully British and quaint?

What's a phrase you've heard recently, or one your grandparents always used, that you think deserves a comeback?

- We all have those 'little domestic discoveries' that feel like a stroke of genius, even if they're incredibly simple.

What's a clever little trick or method you've come up with that makes a household chore or daily task just that little bit easier?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could last for millions of years because there's no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can actually smell freshly baked bread whenever a new supply capsule arrives.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic Pringle cans.
- It is illegal to sing out of tune in Maryland, USA.
- The human heart beats approximately 100,000 times a day.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The 'king' in a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.

On this day

Day 221 of the year, 144 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Gangut Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Candida Maria of Jesus; Christian feast day: Edith Stein (St Teresa Benedicta of the Cross); Christian feast day: Firmus and Rusticus. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Butch Warren, American bassist (died 2013)
- 2000 — Arlo Parks, British singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Tyler Smith, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1976 — Rhona Mitra, English actress and singer
- 1968 — Sam Fogarino, American drummer
- 1970 — Thomas Lennon, American actor and comedian
- 1985 — Anna Kendrick, American actress and singer
- 1976 — Jessica Capshaw, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1944 — The United States Forest Service and the Wartime Advertising Council release posters featuring Smokey Bear for the first time.
- 2024 — Voepass Linhas Aéreas Flight 2283 crashes near Vinhedo, São Paulo, killing all 62 people on board.
- 1945 — The Red Army invades Japanese-occupied Manchuria.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1999 — Russian president Boris Yeltsin fires his prime minister, Sergei Stepashin, and for the fourth time fires his entire cabinet.
- 1993 — The Liberal Democratic Party of Japan loses a 38-year hold on national leadership.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1942 — World War II: Battle of Savo Island: Allied naval forces protecting their amphibious forces during the initial stages of the Battle of Guadalcanal are surprised and defeated by an Imperial Japanese Navy cruiser force.
- 1973 — Mars 7 is launched from the USSR.

- 1945 — World War II: Nagasaki is devastated when an atomic bomb, Fat Man, is dropped by the United States B-29 Bockscar. Thirty-five thousand people are killed outright, including 23,200–28,200 Japanese war workers, 2,000 Korean forced workers, and 150 Japanese soldiers.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 222 of the year, 143 days left in 2026. Today Argentine Air Force Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Bessus; Christian feast day: Blane (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Geraint of Dumnonia. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1958 — Jack Richards, English cricketer, coach, and manager
- 1966 — Charlie Dimmock, English gardener and television host
- 1950 — Patti Austin, American singer-songwriter
- 1948 — Nick Stringer, English actor
- 1957 — Fred Ho, American saxophonist, composer, and playwright (died 2014)
- 1984 — Jigar Naik, English cricketer
- 1980 — Aaron Staton, American actor
- 1952 — Diane Venora, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — HRH Prince Al-Muhtadee Billah is proclaimed the crown prince of Brunei with a Royal Proclamation.
- 1977 — In Yonkers, New York, 24-year-old postal employee David Berkowitz ("Son of Sam") is arrested for a series of killings in the New York City area over the period of one year.
- 2024 — Israel strikes Al-Tabaeen school in eastern Gaza City, killing at least 80 Palestinians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1999 — One person is killed and five people are injured in the Los Angeles Jewish Community Center shooting.
- 1988 — Japanese American internment: U.S. President Ronald Reagan signs the Civil Liberties Act of 1988, providing \$20,000 payments to Japanese Americans who were either interned in or relocated by the United States during World War II.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)